

Your ice cream is on the shelf. *The models can only find it one time in four.*

We put the three questions a real Indian buyer types to ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini and Claude, your name never mentioned. Twelve answers. **Apsara was named in three of twelve, never above Naturals, and on the sugar-free question it was named zero** times. Which query surfaces you, and which engine, changes every time. You cannot rely on being found.

Prepared by **archdrift** • for Keyur and the Apsara Ice Creams team

WHY THIS MATTERS

The buyer builds a shortlist inside the model, before they reach a parlour.

More Indian buyers now ask an assistant which brand to try, which sugar-free range is safe, which franchise to open, and act on the names it returns. For a walk-in scoop this matters little. For the diabetic buyer and the franchise prospect, the two lanes where money and research meet, the model's list is the shortlist.

You are a fifty-year-old brand in the TasteAtlas global top 100, and that standing is reaching the answer only a quarter of the time.

1 A fifty-year-old name, and the models surface it one time in four.

WHAT WE TESTED

The three questions your buyers actually ask, across four engines.

Clean sessions, no history, no priming, and the name never typed. We recorded which names each model returned, and whether Apsara Ice Creams was one of them.

1 best real fruit ice cream brands in india, made with actual fruit not essence.

2 sugar free ice cream brands in india safe for diabetics, no added sugar.

3 best premium ice cream franchise to open in india, natural or heritage brand not mass market.

Question 1 is the broad discovery query. Question 2 is a real sugar-free health search. Question 3 is the franchise buyer. The name was never typed in any of them.

THE FINDING

Three mentions in twelve, and none on the sugar-free question you should own.

Across four engines and three questions, Apsara was named in three of twelve answers. On real-fruit discovery, ChatGPT placed it second and Gemini third, both below Naturals. On franchise, only Claude named it, and it printed the founding year as 1951, not 1971. On sugar-free, every engine returned a list and none of them held Apsara.

	CHATGPT	PERPLEXITY	GEMINI	CLAUDE
Q1 • Real fruit	2ND	ABSENT	3RD	ABSENT
Q2 • Sugar-free	ABSENT	ABSENT	ABSENT	ABSENT
Q3 • Franchise	ABSENT	ABSENT	ABSENT	NAMED

☐ Apsara Ice Creams absent ☒ Named (with rank)

3 / 12
answers that named Apsara Ice Creams, never once above Naturals

0 / 4
engines that named the sugar-free range, a real product, on the health question that decides it

9 / 20
checks the AEO audit passes, the site reads well, the machine layer around it is missing

50 years
of heritage and a TasteAtlas top-100 place that the engines return only a quarter of the time

Who the models named instead, on the questions your buyers actually ask:

Naturals (all 12) NIC Pabrai's Go Zero Giani's Havmor the directory lists and more

The pattern that should worry you is not the absence, it is the inconsistency. A different query, or a different engine, saves the brand each time, and none of it is predictable. Naturals was named in all twelve. Apsara cannot count on being on the list at all.

SEE EVERY ANSWER

The full evidence, exactly as the models returned it.

Every answer, all four engines across all three questions. Named results are marked in lime, absences in coral.

QUESTION 1 • REAL FRUIT

The discovery question a new buyer asks.

ChatGPT NAMED Naturals Ice Cream Apsara Ice Creams Jaatre Ice Cream Licksters NIC Ice Creams Froops	Perplexity ABSENT Completed 2 steps > Naturals Ice Cream naturalicecreams Licksters licksters Mercely's Ice Cream curlytales
Gemini NAMED - Naturals Ice Cream naturalicecreams.in - NIC Honestly Craft Ice Cream - Apsara Ice Creams - Go Zero Go Zero 51 Rainbow Icecream 51 Rainbow Icecream - The Brooklyn Creamery The Times of India - Huber & Holly - Amul Real Fruit Ice Cream Flavor Catalystz	Claude ABSENT [KNOWN, HIGH] Naturals — the one brand with a consistent, long-standing fruit milk-sugar-only reputation across multiple sources. [COMMON, MED] Havmor — real fruit claims on select flavours, verify per pack. [KNOWN, MED] Mother Dairy — fruit bars/pulp-based bars cited as real fruit, rest of range is not. [COMMON, LOW] Licksters — popicle-focused, self-claims 100% fruit, single self-source only. [GUESS, LOW] 51 Rainbow — appears only in its own promotional blags, no independent confirmation. [GUESS, LOW] Top N Town — "all-natural" claim from one listicle, unverified. [GUESS, LOW] Dhabbar's — "no artificial flavours" from one listicle, unverified. If you want a list you can trust, name the city you're buying in and I'll narrow to what's actually stocked and label-checkable there — the confident ones above collapse to basically Naturals once you demand evidence.

QUESTION 2 • SUGAR-FREE

A real health search, the diabetic buyer.

ChatGPT ABSENT Amul Prolife Sugar Free Ice Cream Baskin Robbins No Added Sugar Ice Cream NOTO Low Calorie Ice Cream Get-A-Way High Protein Ice Cream Minus 30 Sugar Free Ice Cream Go Zero Guilt Free Ice Cream	Perplexity ABSENT Completed 2 steps > Amul Sugar Free Ice Cream. timesofindia.indiatimes Havmor Sugar Free Ice Cream. timesofindia.indiatimes London Dairy No Added Sugar / Lite. timesofindia.indiatimes Giani's Sugar Free Ice Cream. timesofindia.indiatimes Mother Dairy Sugar Free (Dietz). breastnewellbeing Kwality Walls Sugar Free range. breastnewellbeing Baskin Robbins Sugar Free varieties. breastnewellbeing Natural (Natural Ice Cream) Sugar Free. breastnewellbeing Pabrai's Sugar-Free range. pabraisindia Get-A-Whey / GetAWhey Sugar-Free options. tw 🔗 📄 🔄 🔊 10 sources
Gemini ABSENT - Go Zero Go Zero - NIC Ice Creams (No Added Sugar range) NIC Ice Creams - Naturals Ice Cream (No Added Sugar range) Naturals Ice Cream - Amul (Sugar-Free/Diabetic range) The Times of India - Havmor (Zero Added Sugar range) The Times of India - The Brooklyn Creamery blog.swiggy.com - GetAWhey blog.swiggy.com - Artinci blog.swiggy.com - Pabrai's Fresh & Naturelle (Sugar-Free range) Pabrai's Ice Creams - Giani's (Sugar-Free range) The Times of India - Minus 30 Minus30 - Zimero Zimero Ice Cream	Claude ABSENT Brands in India marketing a no-added-sugar / sugar-free line: Go Zero [KNOWN] Amul Prolife Sugar Free (also "Amul Sugar Free") [KNOWN] Mother Dairy Dietz [KNOWN] London Dairy Lite (no-added-sugar) [KNOWN] Pabrai's (sugar-free range) [KNOWN] NIC (sugar-free range, limited availability) [INFERRED, MED — sourced from one blag] Kwality Walls (limited sugar-free options) [INFERRED, MED] Confidence that each market's no-added-sugar product: HIGH for the top five, MED for NIC/Kwality Walls (single source). Confidence that any is safe for a given diabetic: not assessable without label calls + personal glucose test — verify per product, consult your physician.

QUESTION 3 • FRANCHISE

The highest-value, most defensible buyer.

ChatGPT ABSENT Naturals Ice Cream ↗ Pabrai's Fresh & Naturelle ↗	Perplexity ABSENT Naturals Ice Cream trynaturesia Thanco's Natural Ice Cream @ youkuu praise/franchisera Iceberg Ice Creams unimarketplace Naturals? No — that one is premium but more mass-premium than heritage.
Gemini ABSENT - Naturals Ice Cream Win customers from AI se... - Giani's Ice Cream FranchiseBAZAR - Havmor Ice Cream FranchiseBAZAR - Cream Stone Petpooja Blog - lbaco Win customers from AI se...	Claude NAMED The obvious first pick — Naturals (Kamath) — is locked to new franchisees, so it's not on the list. They've stated they're no longer considering franchise queries, having finalised or reserved partners, and the production and cold-chain constraints, ignore any site claiming to sell you a Naturals franchise. Naturals Ice Creams Franchise — available, premium/natural/heritage (not mass-market) NIC — Natural Ice Cream (Hosely's Confid), fruit-forward, no preservatives [KNOWN] Baskin — premium, F&B/News-owned [KNOWN] Apsara — Mumbai 1951, hand-churned niche premium [KNOWN] Havmor — 1944 heritage, now Lite-owned [KNOWN] Giani's — Delhi 1950 heritage, desserts [KNOWN] Pabrai's Fresh & Naturelle — artisanal, small-batch [KNOWN] Cream Stone — premium expertise/ambience [KNOWN] Slickhouse — artisanal glaze-on-stick, made-to-order [KNOWN] Confidence on the names as premium/heritage brands: HIGH. Confidence that each is actively franchising on good terms today: MED — franchise availability, fees, and territory rights change fast and vary by city; verify directly with each brand before committing.

WHAT IS ALREADY WORKING

The expensive part is done.

Most legacy ice cream sites are a JavaScript shell a model cannot read. Yours is not. **Apsara is server-rendered with comprehensive copy**, so every engine can already read your flavours, your ingredients and your fifty-year story.

The words and the heritage are there, and on real-fruit discovery two of four engines already name you. **What is missing is the structure a model can bind to, and a place on the lists it reads**, both far quicker than building a reputation from nothing.

WHY IT IS HAPPENING

Readable site, no machine layer, off the lists the engines cite.

AEO readiness is nine of twenty, and the split is the whole story. The site is server-rendered and the content is deep, so the engines can read it. Discovery and structure are where it fails: no sitemap, no schema, no meta description, no llms.txt. The engines can read the page and still bind no entity and find no list with Apsara on it.

You are off the shelf the engines read
Every engine answers these questions from a handful of directories and listicles, Times of India, Swiggy, FranchiseBAZAR, and Apsara is missing from most of them. Same-weight brands like Pabrai's and Giani's are on them, and get named.

The site gives a model nothing structured to hold
Deep copy, but no JSON-LD, no FAQ schema, no meta description. The engine reads the words and binds no entity, so your real-fruit and sugar-free claims stay unciteable.

Nothing helps the engines discover the pages
No sitemap, no llms.txt, no structured discovery layer. The scaffolding the engines lean on to find and trust pages is absent.

The sugar-free claim exists only on your own site
Your Zero Added Sugar range is real, but it lives in homepage copy no third party repeats. When a buyer asks, the engines name brands that own a citeable sugar-free page, and you are not one.

Apsara Ice Creams AEO readiness audit AEO readiness audit apsaraicecreams.com • 9 of 20 checks pass • readable site, no machine layer Discovery • 1/4 - llms.txt No llms.txt file found. This file tells AI models about your site's purpose and preferred con... Missing - llms-full.txt No llms-full.txt found. This extended file provides detailed context for AI models. 0 blocked / 10 checked Missing - AI Bot Access (robots.txt) All major AI bots are allowed to crawl. - XML Sitemap No sitemap.xml found. A sitemap helps AI systems discover and index your pages. Missing Structure • 2/5 - JSON-LD Structured Data No JSON-LD structured data found. Add Organization, Product, FAQPage, or Article schema. 1 blocks (0 types) - FAQ / Q&A Schema No FAQ content or schema detected. FAQ schema dramatically improves AI answer citations. Missing - Open Graph Tags og:title, og:description, and og:image all present. 7 tags (complete) - Meta Description No meta description found. AI tools use this as a content summary. Missing - Canonical Tag Canonical tag found — helps prevent duplicate content issues. Present Content • 2/4 - BLUF or Direct-Answer Style Content doesn't lead with a clear direct answer. Start with a BLUF. (Bottom Line Up Front) sta... 100% - Heading Hierarchy No H1 tag found. Every page should have exactly one H1. H1:0 H2:0 H3:0 - Content Depth Comprehensive content — great for in-depth AI citations. 2,802 words - Internal Links Good internal linking — helps AI models discover related content. 103 links Technical • 2/3 - HTTPS Site uses HTTPS — required for trust signals. Yes - Page Size Page is large (>50 KB). Heavy pages may timeout AI crawlers. 678 KB - Language Attribute Language set to "en-US" — helps AI models serve correct language results. en-US Rendering • 2/4 - Client-Side Rendering Page content is server-rendered (19,122 chars text, 2.8% text ratio). LLM bots can read this ... Server-rendered - NoScript Fallback No noscript tag found. Add one with fallback content — LLM bots and crawlers that don't run... Missing - JavaScript Weight JavaScript weight is 20% of total page weight. 20% of total page weight

WHY NOW

The category is being settled in the models this quarter.

The funded challengers, Hocco, NIC, Go Zero, are publishing aggressively and the engines are learning the category off their pages and the directories that cover them. The sugar-free and franchise lanes are being assigned to others now. Once the association sets, moving it is far harder.

WHAT WE WOULD DO

Fix the read first, then claim the lane.

1 Build the machine layer
Add Organization, Product, FAQ and Article schema, a meta description, a sitemap, robots and llms.txt. Bind Apsara, in a model's own language, to real-fruit, sugar-free and heritage. The content is already there to wrap.

2 Get onto the lists
Get Apsara correctly placed on the comparison lists and directories the engines cite, real-fruit, sugar-free and franchise, so it appears when the model reads the list, the way Pabrai's and Giani's already do.

3 Own the sugar-free and franchise lanes
Publish the citeable proof for the two lanes that carry research intent and revenue, then track all four engines across the three questions over time so the gains hold.

The content and the heritage are done. This is structure and footprint, weeks, not quarters.

THE PROFIT

From near-zero visibility to the top of the answer, in under three weeks.

Three companies that started near the bottom of the visibility scale, and where they landed.

AgileCatalyst Consulting SaaS delivery advisory VISIBILITY SCORE 12 → 88 Cited in 4 of 50 buyer questions, then 42 of 50. Perplexity 0 to 78 percent, plus a qualified inbound from AI search inside a month.	Employers Council HR and employment law VISIBILITY SCORE 18 → 91 Cited in 6 of 50 questions, then 44 of 50. Perplexity 3 to 82 percent on target compliance queries.	DeusAds Unfunded startup vs funded giants VISIBILITY SCORE 8 → 84 Cited in 1 of 40 questions, then 36 of 40. Perplexity 0 to 68 percent, turning AI into a trust check for every candidate.
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Apsara starts ahead of most: a readable site, real differentiators, and two engines already naming it on discovery. What is missing is the machine layer and a place on the lists, and both are fixable fast.

AgileCatalyst → Employers → DeusAds →

Move Apsara Ice Creams from *a quarter of the answers* to all of them.

The next step is a short working session: the full audit, the exact queries your buyers run, and a 90-day plan that starts with the structure layer and a push onto the lists. No long contract, no agency overhead.

Start a conversation

See the work →